Stack depth quick card

Use the **effective stack**. Same number of hands, different hands; weaker hands get all in as stacks shrink.

STACK	OPEN	FACING AN OPEN	FACING A 3-BET OR JAM	POSTFLOP
100bb+	Suited, connected, small pairs, suited aces	Call in position; 3-bet polarised (A5s, suited connectors as bluffs)	Call wide in position; set-mine	Two pair+ to stack off; pot-control one pair
40–60bb	Same %, swap small pairs and small SCs for KJo, KTo, ATo, A9o	3-bet bluffs with blockers (KJo, KTo, ATo, A9s–A6s); 3-bet AQ, AJs for value	Call less; 4-bet jam appears; no set-mining	SRP: top pair good kicker strong; 3-bet pot: any top pair commits
20–35bb	Smaller opens; BTN tightens; some jams at 20bb	Re-jam or call; small 3-bets vanish	Calling a jam needs a hand ahead of their range	Top pair good kicker = stack off; bet small
10–20bb	Min-raise premiums; open-shove the middle hands	Re-jam or fold (BB can call a min-raise)	Call shoves with hands ahead of the jam range	After a min-raise: any pair or good draw
Under 10bb	Push or fold; wider the later and shorter	—	Call wider against shorter shoves	—

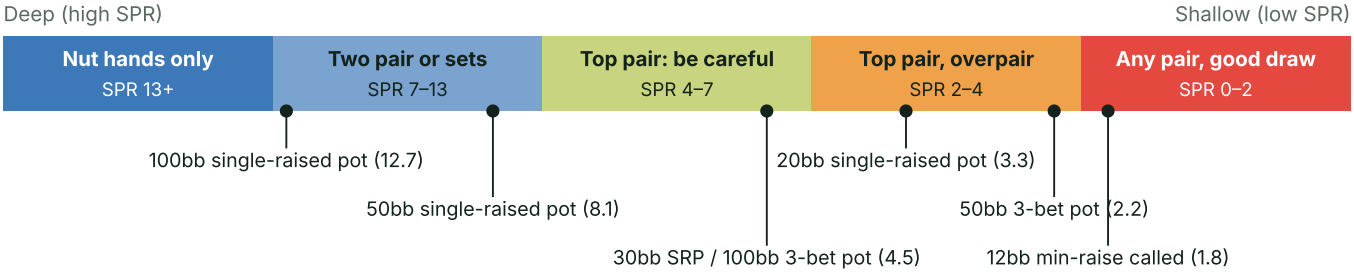


Figure 6. The SPR ladder: how strong a hand you need to get all the chips in. Each band names the weakest hand that is usually strong enough to stack off at that SPR (rough guide). Dots mark typical spots from your charts and solves (BB ante, about 2.2bb opens).

HAND TYPE	100BB+	40–60BB	20–35BB	10–20BB	UNDER 10BB	WHY
Small pairs (22–66)	●●●	●○○	●○○	●●●	●●●	set-mining deep; all-in equity short
Suited connectors (54s–T9s)	●●●	●●○	●○○	●○○	●○○	need deep stacks to pay off
Suited wheel aces (A2s–A5s)	●●●	●●○	●●○	●●●	●●●	flush/wheel deep; ace blocker short
Offsuit Broadways (KJo, QJo, KTo)	●○○	●●●	●●●	●●●	●●○	make top pairs you can stack off with
Weak offsuit aces (A2o–A9o)	●○○	●○○	●●○	●●●	●●●	blockers and all-in equity
Big pairs and AK	●●●	●●●	●●●	●●●	●●●	always good; play bigger pots shallower

Figure 1. Which hands gain and lose value. ●●● = most valuable at that depth. Small pairs and wheel aces are worth most at both ends: deep for their big hands, short because all-in equity and an ace blocker are what matter.

Bubble quick card

Chips lost cost more than chips won are worth. Required equity = pot odds + risk premium.

YOU ARE... / THEY ARE...	SHORT STACK	MEDIUM STACK	BIG STACK
Short stack	Moderate	High	High · +9–15%
Medium stack	Low	Very high	Very high
Big stack	Very low	Moderate	Highest · +18–35%

Figure 7. Risk premium on the bubble: extra equity you need, on top of pot odds, to call an all-in (or make one). The two numbers come from Jonathan Little's guide; the rest is the same logic: the more a loss costs you and the less a win helps, the higher it is. Rough guide only: real spots depend on every stack in the tournament.

Big stack	Open, 3-bet and defend wider; small bets postflop; fold when clearly behind or nobody folds.
Medium stack	Avoid big stacks (tighten with one on your left); pressure medium and short stacks.
Short stack	Shove, don't min-raise and call off; fold marginal call-offs; pressure other short stacks.
Bluffs	Hold an ace: it blocks the hands that call or jam.
Example	10bb BB vs 40bb SB jam: need ~56% (44+, A6s+, A8o+, K6s+, K8o+, Q8s+, JTs).
Payouts	Care about pay jumps that matter; don't lock up early for a min-cash.

Top mistakes

1. **Calling opens with small pairs and suited connectors at 30bb or less.** Fold them: at 30bb there is only about 12 times the call behind, below the 15–20× they need, and players behind can squeeze (Figure 4). Exception: closing the action in the big blind.
2. **Calling 3-bets with small pairs at 40bb or less.** Fold or jam them: set-mining needs about 15–20 times the call behind, and at 50bb you have about 6× (Figure 5). Call opens with them only in position or in the big blind.
3. **Stacking off with one pair when 150bb+ deep.** Keep pots small with one pair deep; get it in with two pair or better.
4. **Opening the same hands at every depth.** Swap small pairs and small suited connectors for offsuit Broadways as you get shorter (Figure 2).
5. **Making 3-bets you can't call a jam with, at 20–35bb.** Re-jam or flat instead; small 3-bets with medium hands get shoved on.
6. **Min-raising at 15bb, then calling off light.** Shove the hands you don't want to face a re-jam with; min-raise only hands happy to call or easy to fold.